

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 990

By Rose

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Bartlett Panthers boys' basketball team upon winning the 2026 TSSAA Division I, Class 4A state championship.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly should salute those student athletes who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as true champions of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such exemplary group of young men is the Panthers boys' basketball team of Bartlett High School in Shelby County, whose members have proven themselves to be the fiercest of competitors and truly worthy of admiration by winning a TSSAA state championship for the first time in twenty-five years; and

WHEREAS, there were high expectations for Bartlett this season, as the nationally ranked Panthers were the overwhelming favorites to win the state title; despite facing this pressure, the team did not blink but instead excelled at every level of competition to claim the school's second Gold Ball trophy as Class 4A champions; and

WHEREAS, after winning their district and regional tournaments, Bartlett destroyed Rossvie in the sectional round to punch their ticket for the Big Dance at Middle Tennessee State University's Murphy Center; and

WHEREAS, the Panthers bested Brentwood 65-56 in the quarterfinals and defeated Bearden 71-61 in the semifinal round of the state tournament; and

WHEREAS, in the title tilt, Bartlett rolled over Walker Valley 69-47 behind the game-high 15 points, six rebounds, and four blocked shots posted by senior Axton Perry, a Southeast Missouri State signee, to claim the laurels of a state champion; and

WHEREAS, there was certainly no shortage of dynamic talent on the Panthers' championship squad; junior Dylan Jones was named the state tournament's Most Valuable Player after scoring 22 points in the quarterfinals, 22 points in the semifinals, and nine points in the final match-up; Dylan has been named to the 2025-2026 ALL-USA Southeast Boys' Basketball Team and is ranked as the No. 49 player in the 2027 class; and

WHEREAS, DJ Okoth, who was honored as Class 4A Mr. Basketball in his sophomore season, scored eight points in the championship game; DJ is ranked as the No. 15 prospect in the 2028 class; and

WHEREAS, in addition to winning the state title, Bartlett posted an outstanding 35-4 overall record without suffering a loss to an opponent from Tennessee and was nationally ranked No. 12 in the *USA Today Sports Super 25* rankings; and

WHEREAS, the Panthers' superb performance would not have been possible without the expert guidance of Head Coach Dion Real and the unfailing support of the players' families, their fans, and the Bartlett community; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Bartlett High School boys' basketball team epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, the perseverance, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young men not only made possible a championship season but also surely bode well for their future success; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the Bartlett Panthers for their outstanding season on the hardwood; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the Bartlett High School

Panthers boys' basketball team upon winning the 2026 TSSAA Division I, Class 4A state championship and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.